The video too created waves, and full credit goes to the team of ADG PI, then Maj Gen DP Pandey, and the Asgaonkars, Prabhu and Manika, a husband-and-wife team of Sparkleworks Films, who translated our concept into reality.[5]

Visiting numerous units and formations, listening to their operational briefings and attending the war games (WG) of the various Corps is a major and important function. One of the first WGs that I attended was of the 16 Corps based at Nagrota, near Jammu. The setting was in the context of a Dynamic Response to a terrorist incident as happened after Pulwama (incident) and Balakot (response). This was the first time we were playing out such a scenario. During the WG, the situation played out in an escalatory manner, culminating in a conventional full-fledged war. That is not quite how I viewed it. In my scheme of things, each possible incident should have a proportionate and matching response limited to that provocation. The level and manner of the response would depend on the intensity of the incident, and to that end, we should have a number of plans, prepared and rehearsed, that can be put into effect within hours of any untoward incident. This punitive, retaliatory action had to be immediate to send the correct message. Over the next few months and with other Corps WGs, we further refined this thought process and prepared outline plans, which could be presented to the CCS at a moment's notice, as and when the need arose. Thankfully, such an eventuality did not arise. Two aspects that emerged in most of our WGs though, is that we tend to play out the situations in isolation with little regard to the bigger picture. The situation in other Commands/fronts, what the other Services are doing, developments in the national, international arena, etc., are ignored and we willy-nilly revert to our comfort zone—conventional operations and force-on-force application of combat power. There is no guile or cunning. The

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